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WORDPRESS PLUGIN · USER GUIDE

MBR Cookie Consent

Enterprise-grade consent management for WordPress — global privacy law coverage, blocking that survives a page cache, a diagnostics panel that checks what your pages actually request, and 22 translations. Genuinely free.

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Section 20 is new in this revision. Sections 8, 9, 12 and 18 have changed materially, and section 9 describes two services that earlier versions listed as blocked but never blocked.

1. Introduction

MBR Cookie Consent is a complete, professional-grade consent management platform for WordPress — and it is entirely free. No premium tier, no upsells, no monthly fees, and no third-party branding forced onto your banner.

It was built on a simple frustration: privacy compliance had become something businesses were expected to pay hundreds of pounds a year for, often in exchange for a banner that displayed someone else's logo. Every feature you would expect from an enterprise consent platform is included, fully documented, and yours to configure however your site needs.

What this plugin does

- Displays a customisable, accessible consent banner that respects the visitor's choices.
- Blocks non-essential scripts, embeds, images and stylesheets until the visitor consents.
- Adjusts automatically to the visitor's region, applying the correct privacy law.
- Integrates with Google Consent Mode v2 and Microsoft UET.
- Blocks form submissions server-side until consent is granted — even with JavaScript disabled.
- Keeps an exportable, audit-ready record of every consent interaction.
- Generates a privacy policy, including the AI training disclosure required in Connecticut.
- **Checks its own work**, including by loading a page and recording what it actually requests. See section 20.
- Shows the banner in the visitor's own language, in 22 community-contributed translations.
- Works correctly behind a page cache, which most consent plugins quietly do not.
- Exports and imports its own configuration, across single sites and Multisite networks.

New in version 2.4.8

Two services were listed as blocked and never were

Google Fonts was in the built-in service list, described as a script. It arrives as a stylesheet link, and the plugin had no stylesheet handling at all — so the rule was listed, counted in the totals, and matched nothing. Every site using Google Fonts has been sending visitors' IP addresses to Google before consent.

Images could not be blocked by a custom rule. The three rule types all rewrote scripts and embeds, so a rule against an image host was accepted, shown in the list, and could never fire. WordPress puts Gravatar avatars on comment threads as ordinary images, which sends the visitor's IP address to Automattic before consent. Tracking pixels are the same shape.

Both are fixed, and there are now Image and Stylesheet rule types for anything else of that kind. See section 9.

Important

If you use Google Fonts, your typography will fall back to a system font until a visitor consents. That is the correct behaviour and it is visible, so expect to be asked about it. **Self-hosting your font files removes the disclosure entirely and avoids the fallback**, and is usually the better answer.

The Consent Doctor

A new screen that answers “is my consent setup actually working?” — including by loading a page of your site and recording the network requests it really makes. Both faults above were found that way. See section 20.

Geolocation reporting

A region resolved just now is now told apart from one read from cache, with its age, and failed lookups are recorded so an intermittent fault stays visible. A successful lookup is cached for a day and a failure for five minutes, so simply looking at the current state was biased heavily towards good news. See section 12.

Other changes

- **Settings could fail to save entirely.** All eight tabs are one form with one Save button, so a single field the plugin would not accept discarded every setting on every tab. Now only that field is left alone, everything else saves, and the notice names it.
- **The settings error notice says what actually happened,** including when the server sends back something unreadable — which means a PHP error has been printed into it.
- **Policy link wording corrected.** The links work before consent is given, and deliberately so — a visitor has to read your policies in order to choose about them.

2. Requirements & Compatibility

MBR Cookie Consent is designed to run comfortably on standard WordPress hosting.

Requirement	Minimum	Recommended
WordPress	5.8	6.5 or newer
PHP	7.4	8.1 or newer
MySQL / MariaDB	5.7 / 10.3	8.0 / 10.6 or newer
HTTPS	Strongly advised	Required for accurate consent records

Tested integrations

- **Page builders:** Elementor, plus the standard WordPress block editor.
- **Form plugins:** Contact Form 7, WPForms, Gravity Forms, Elementor Forms.
- **Multilingual:** WPML and Polylang.
- **Caching:** SiteGround Speed Optimizer, WP Rocket, LiteSpeed, W3 Total Cache, WP Super Cache, WP Fastest Cache, WP-Optimize, Cache Enabler, Breeze, Nginx Helper and WP Engine are purged automatically on save. See section 23.

Note

If you run a performance plugin that delays JavaScript until a visitor interacts with the page, the Consent Doctor's live check needs the consent scripts excluded from that delay — nobody ever interacts with a background frame. The plugin marks its own diagnostic script accordingly, but your own trackers still need to load early enough to be held. See sections 20 and 25.

3. Installation & Activation

Installing the plugin

- Download the latest `mbr-cookie-consent.zip` from littlewebshack.com.
- In your WordPress admin, go to **Plugins > Add New > Upload Plugin**.
- Choose the downloaded ZIP file and select **Install Now**, then **Activate**.

First activation

On activation the plugin creates its database tables for consent logging and registers a new admin menu. A default banner configuration is applied immediately so your site is never left without a banner while you finish setting up.

Tip

Updating is safe — your settings and consent records are preserved. Take a routine backup first, as you would with any change to a live site. After updating to 2.4.8, run the Consent Doctor once: it will tell you whether the schema change took and whether anything is escaping your blocking rules.

4. Quick Start: Compliant in Five Minutes

Step 1 — Run the cookie scanner

Open **MBR Cookie Consent** › **Scanner** and run a one-click scan. The plugin crawls your pages and lists the scripts and iframes it finds, suggesting a category for each.

Step 2 — Confirm your categories

Review the detected items under Necessary, Analytics, Marketing and Preferences, and adjust any that were placed in the wrong category.

Step 3 — Set your region behaviour

Under **Compliance**, enable geolocation so visitors are shown the banner matching their jurisdiction. Set a sensible default region — it is what visitors see whenever detection cannot resolve a location.

Step 4 — Style the banner

In **Appearance**, set your colours, choose your logo, and pick a layout. Use **Preview banner** to see the result at desktop and mobile widths before saving.

Step 5 — Check it actually works

Open **MBR Cookie Consent** › **Consent Doctor** and run the live check on your home page, then on a post with comments and a page with an embedded video. That is the step that tells you whether the configuration you just made is doing anything. See section 20.

Note

When testing by hand rather than with the Doctor, always use a private window. A normal one may already hold a consent choice from earlier testing, which hides the banner and makes it look as though nothing is happening.

5. The Consent Banner

Banner actions

Action	What it does
Accept All	Grants consent to every category and unblocks all held resources.
Reject All	Declines all non-essential categories; only necessary cookies run.
Customise	Opens the Preference Centre for category-by-category control.

Banner behaviour

- Until a choice is made, all non-essential resources remain held by default.
- The visitor's choice is stored and respected on subsequent visits.
- A floating revisit button lets visitors reopen and change their choice at any time.

- Consent can be set to expire after a defined period, prompting re-confirmation.
- On HTTPS sites the consent cookie is marked Secure, so it is never sent in cleartext.

Important

Equal prominence between Accept and Reject is required in several jurisdictions, including the EU and UK. The default banner gives both buttons equal weight — avoid restyling one to be far more prominent.

6. Banner Customisation

Option	Details
Layout	Banner position and shape — a bottom bar, a corner box, or a centred modal.
Colours	Background, text, button and accent colours to match your brand.
Custom text	Rewrite the heading, body copy and button labels in your own voice.
Logo	Choose from the Media Library, or paste a URL for a logo hosted elsewhere.
Glassmorphism	A frosted-glass effect for the banner, with Opacity and Blur sliders.
Dark mode	Off, follow the visitor's system setting, or always on.

Policy links

You can add links to your privacy and cookie policies. A link appears once its checkbox is ticked **and** its URL is filled in — both are needed, and the link is silently omitted if the URL is blank.

Note

The policy links work before any consent is given, and that is deliberate: a visitor has to be able to read your policies in order to make an informed choice about them. Consent is never required to follow them.

The contrast readout

Beside the glassmorphism sliders is a live WCAG 2.1 contrast ratio. Rather than capping how transparent the banner may be, the screen composites your banner colour, text colour and opacity over both a white and a black backdrop and reports the worse of the two. If that figure passes, the banner is legible over any page behind it.

Tip

Keep text and buttons at a contrast ratio meeting WCAG 2.1 AA — at least 4.5:1 for normal text. Treat anything below that as a problem to fix rather than a warning to dismiss.

7. Cookie Categories & the Preference Centre

Category	Purpose	Blocked by default?
Necessary	Essential for the site to function; cannot be switched off.	No — always allowed
Analytics	Measurement and statistics, e.g. Google Analytics.	Yes
Marketing	Advertising and cross-site tracking.	Yes

Category	Purpose	Blocked by default?
Preferences	Remembering choices, plus embeds and web fonts.	Yes

- Each non-necessary category has a clear on/off control.
- A short description explains what each category is for, in plain language.
- Visitors can accept some categories and decline others, then save.
- Choices take effect immediately — declined categories stay held.

8. Cookie Scanner & Script Management

One-click scanning

The scanner crawls your site and detects scripts and iframes that set cookies or load third-party resources. Each detected item is listed with a suggested category.

Important

The scanner reads your pages as they are delivered by the server. Anything added afterwards by JavaScript — most tag manager containers, and much of what actually leaks — is invisible to it. The live check in section 20 is what catches those, because it watches a real page load instead.

Adding a rule by hand

Where the scanner cannot reach something, add it yourself. The rule type matters, because each one rewrites a different kind of tag:

Type	Use it for
External (src)	A script loaded from another host — analytics, chat widgets, pixels delivered as JavaScript.
Inline	A block of JavaScript written directly into the page.
Iframe	An embedded player, map or widget, including click-to-play facades.
Image	Anything delivered as a picture — Gravatar avatars, tracking pixels, remote badges. <i>New in 2.4.8.</i>
Stylesheet	Web fonts and external CSS. <i>New in 2.4.8.</i>

Important

Picking the wrong type produces a rule that is accepted, listed, and never fires. Until 2.4.8 there were no Image or Stylesheet types at all, so a rule against an avatar or a web font could not work however it was configured. If you added one before updating, re-save it with the right type — nothing else will reveal that it was doing nothing.

Note

Run the scanner again whenever you add a new third-party service, and follow it with a live check. Newly added trackers are not held until the plugin knows about them.

9. Automatic Script Blocking

This is the engine behind genuine compliance. Rather than simply hiding a banner, the plugin prevents non-essential resources from loading until the visitor has consented for the relevant category.

How it works

- Every visitor is served the same page, with all non-necessary resources held inert.
- The browser then releases whatever the visitor's stored choice permits.
- If consent is declined, they never load, and no cookies they would set are written.
- Necessary resources are never held, so core site functionality is unaffected.

What can be held

Kind	How it is held
Scripts	The type is changed so the browser will not execute it; restored on consent.
Iframes and embeds	The source is moved aside and a placeholder shown in its place.
Click-to-play facades	Recognised by technique rather than by product, so any performance plugin's version is covered.
Poster images	A facade avoids the provider's cookies but still fetches its thumbnail, which discloses the visitor's IP address. A transparent placeholder stands in, so the layout does not move.
Images (2.4.8)	The source is replaced with a transparent placeholder and the real address kept for restoring on consent.
Stylesheets (2.4.8)	The address is moved aside. A stylesheet link with no address fetches nothing, whereas most other techniques still fetch at low priority.

Two services that were never actually held

Worth stating plainly, because both shipped for a long time and neither was visible from any screen in the plugin.

Google Fonts. It was in the built-in service list and described as a script. It arrives as a stylesheet link, and there was no stylesheet handling anywhere in the plugin, so the rule matched nothing on any site. Loading it discloses the visitor's IP address to Google, which a German court has held unlawful under the GDPR. Holding the stylesheet also stops the font files themselves, because those are fetched by the stylesheet rather than by the page.

Images. Custom rules offered three types, all of which rewrote scripts or embeds. A rule against an image host was accepted and displayed but could never fire. WordPress emits Gravatar avatars as ordinary images on any comment thread, sending the visitor's IP address to Automattic before consent.

Good to know

Both were found by the live check described in section 20, not by reading the code — a rule that exists and never fires looks correct from every angle except the network.

Why the page is always blocked

Blocking happens for everybody, without reference to any cookie, so the page is identical for every visitor and safe for a cache to store. A visitor who has accepted has their resources released a moment after the page arrives rather than as it is parsed. This is how every mature consent platform works, and it is the only arrangement that is correct behind a cache. See section 23.

10. Consent Mode Integration

Framework	What it covers
Google Consent Mode v2	Signals <code>ad_storage</code> , <code>analytics_storage</code> and the v2 ad-personalisation parameters to Google tags.
Microsoft UET Consent Mode	Passes consent state to the Microsoft Advertising Universal Event Tracking tag.

How the signal is sent

The page always declares a denied default, identical for every visitor, and the visitor's actual choice is sent as an update from their browser before any Google or Microsoft tag loads. This is what the Consent Mode specification asks for, and it is also the only arrangement that survives a page cache.

Important

IAB TCF and Google Additional Consent Mode were removed, in 2.3.3 and 2.3.4. Neither ever functioned. Supporting TCF properly requires registration as a Consent Management Platform with IAB Europe. If you run programmatic advertising and need TCF, you need a registered CMP — this plugin covers GDPR, UK, CCPA and the other regimes in section 13, none of which require it.

11. Form Builder Integration

This is the feature that sets MBR Cookie Consent apart. Most plugins block forms with JavaScript alone, which anyone can bypass by disabling JavaScript. This plugin enforces consent on the server.

When a visitor submits a form before granting the required consent, the submission is intercepted on the server and held. Because the check happens server-side, it cannot be circumvented by turning off JavaScript or editing the page.

Supported builders

- Contact Form 7
- WPForms
- Gravity Forms
- Elementor Forms

The Elementor experience

- A clean dark overlay modal replaces inline error messages.
- The visitor is offered **Accept Cookies** or **Not Now**.
- On acceptance, the pending submission is re-sent automatically with all entered data intact — the visitor does not have to retype anything.

Tip

The automatic re-submission replays the original request after consent. If you use a heavily customised form setup, test the full submit-block-accept-resubmit cycle before launch.

12. Geolocation & Regional Compliance

Model	Typical regions	Banner behaviour
Opt-in	EU / EEA, United Kingdom, Switzerland, Quebec, Brazil, India, Vietnam, Indonesia, Nigeria, China, South Korea, Saudi Arabia, South Africa	Held until the visitor actively accepts.
Opt-out	Much of the United States	May run, with a clear way to opt out / 'Do Not Sell'.
Notice	Canada (federal), Australia	Visitors are informed; behaviour follows local rules.

How the region is applied

The region is resolved in the browser. The page itself is identical for every visitor — which is what makes it safe to cache — and the browser asks the site which region applies, then adjusts the banner accordingly. If the lookup cannot complete, the visitor sees the banner your own settings describe.

Knowing whether detection actually worked

The **Current Detection** panel shows the country and region you would be given, and a **Source** line saying how that was arrived at: Cloudflare's header, your configured lookup provider, the fallback provider, or not detected at all.

From 2.4.8 it also says whether the answer was **resolved just now or read from cache**, and how old it is.

Important

That distinction matters more than it sounds. A successful lookup is cached for 24 hours and a failure for only five minutes, so checking the current state at any given moment is biased heavily towards good news: a site whose provider fails one request in three would look perfectly healthy every time anybody looked. Failed lookups are now recorded separately and reported for a day, so an intermittent fault stays visible. Visitors served during that window saw the wrong region.

Note

If the Source line says **not detected**, you are looking at your configured default region and not a lookup result. Every visitor whose location cannot be resolved is being shown it — so if it is not the region you expect, your visitors are seeing the wrong banner.

If your site is behind Cloudflare

Cloudflare can tell the plugin which country a visitor is in at no cost and with no outbound request. Where that header is present and trusted it is used automatically, whichever provider is selected — it is faster than any lookup service, cannot be rate-limited, and sends no visitor IP address to a third party.

Important

Cloudflare does not send the country header by default. Switch it on per domain: **Network > IP Geolocation > On** adds the country header only, which is all this plugin uses, and is the quicker route. Alternatively **Rules > Settings > Managed Transforms**, enabling *Add visitor location headers*. On older dashboards that sits under Rules > Transform Rules. If the header still does not arrive, check that *Remove visitor IP headers* is not enabled.

Choosing a lookup provider

This is the fallback for requests that do not arrive through Cloudflare. **ipapi.co** is the default: free, and served over HTTPS. **ip-api.com** offers a higher free rate limit but only serves HTTPS on its paid tier.

Note

ip-api.com without a pro key does nothing. The plugin will not send a visitor's IP address over plain HTTP without an explicit opt-in, so there is no endpoint there it is willing to call. Lookups fall through to ipapi.co, and the screen shows a notice explaining it.

Important

Check your provider's terms before going live. Both lookup services are third parties with their own licensing, and their free tiers are generally offered for non-commercial, testing or development use. If this is a commercial site, confirm you are within them — or use the Cloudflare option, which makes no outbound request at all.

Visitor IP Detection

Mode	When to use it
Automatic (default)	Trusts Cloudflare's header when the request demonstrably came through Cloudflare — either from a published Cloudflare address, or where your host has already restored the visitor IP from Cloudflare's own header.
Trusted proxies	You sit behind a known load balancer or CDN. Supply its addresses and only those are believed.
Direct	No proxy in front of the site. Forwarding headers are ignored entirely.

Important

Geolocation tells you where a visitor appears to be; it is not legal advice. If you operate in a regulated sector or are unsure which model applies, confirm your obligations with a qualified adviser.

13. Privacy Law Reference

A plain-language summary, not a statement of legal compliance for your specific circumstances. Current as of September 2026.

Law / framework	Region	Consent model
GDPR	EU / EEA	Prior opt-in for non-essential cookies
UK DUAA	United Kingdom	Opt-in, handled separately from EU GDPR
CCPA / CPRA	California, USA	Opt-out, with 'Do Not Sell or Share'
US state laws	24 states enacted, 20 in effect	Opt-out, varying by state
Quebec Law 25	Quebec, Canada	Express opt-in, French-language banner
revFADP	Switzerland	Opt-in, GDPR-equivalent
LGPD	Brazil	Opt-in for non-essential cookies
India DPDP Act	India	Notice and consent for personal data
Vietnam PDPL	Vietnam	Opt-in, granular per-purpose consent

Law / framework	Region	Consent model
Indonesia UU PDP	Indonesia	Opt-in, purpose-specific with easy withdrawal
Nigeria NDPA + GAID	Nigeria	Opt-in, prominent banner required
China PIPL	China	Opt-in; separate consent for transfers
South Korea PIPA	South Korea	Opt-in where cookies identify a person
Saudi Arabia PDPL	Saudi Arabia	Opt-in; consent is the default basis
South Africa POPIA	South Africa	Opt-in for direct marketing
Global Privacy Control	Browser-level signal	Honoured automatically as an opt-out

Important

China needs work beyond the banner. PIPL requires a separate, standalone consent for transferring personal information outside mainland China, plus an approved transfer mechanism. This plugin provides neither.

European Union — status

The proposed ePrivacy Regulation was withdrawn: announced in the Commission's Work Programme on 11 February 2025, approved 16 July 2025, published in the Official Journal 6 October 2025. The Directive, as amended, remains the controlling instrument.

The Digital Omnibus, which would move cookie rules into the GDPR as new Articles 88a and 88b, split in two. The AI half was adopted by the Council on 29 June 2026; the data half remains in negotiation, and the Council's compromise text of 21 May 2026 deleted the cookie-consent relocation entirely. **Single-click refusal, the six-month cooldown and the proposed low-risk exemptions are proposals only. Nothing to reconfigure.**

On enforcement: in July 2026 the EDPB issued Binding Decision 1/2026, instructing a supervisory authority to decide a cookie-banner complaint on its merits rather than dismissing it as an abuse of process. Representative complaints are now much harder to dispose of on procedural grounds.

United States — recent changes

Connecticut's amended act took effect on 1 July 2026, dropping the coverage threshold to 35,000 consumers and removing it entirely for any business that processes sensitive data or sells personal data — so a small site can now be in scope. SB 4 follows on 1 October 2026 with facial recognition rules, a flat ban on selling precise geolocation, revised treatment of publicly available information, and data broker registration from 1 January 2027.

Change	Effect
Maryland (1 July 2026)	"Precise geolocation" widened to a consumer, mobile device or vehicle within a 1,750-foot radius.
Virginia (1 July 2026)	Outright prohibition on selling or offering to sell precise geolocation information.
New Jersey (30 June 2026)	Bans the sale of sensitive data by any entity, with no consumer-volume threshold — so it reaches sites well below that state's own applicability thresholds.

Important

The direction of travel matters more than any single amendment. Sensitive categories — precise location above all — are moving from “opt-out with consent” to “may not be sold at all”. An opt-out link does not satisfy a flat prohibition. If you sell or share location data, that is a question for your adviser rather than a banner setting.

Four new comprehensive laws were enacted in the 2026 session, bringing the total to 24: Oklahoma SB 546 and the Louisiana Data Privacy Act (both 1 January 2027), the Alabama Personal Data Protection Act (1 May 2027) and the Vermont Data Privacy and Online Surveillance Act (1 January 2028). All follow the Virginia opt-out model, so no banner change is required. Two carry provisions worth noting: Vermont requires the same AI training disclosure as Connecticut, and Oklahoma treats pseudonymous data as personal data wherever it can reasonably be linked to a person, which brings cookie identifiers squarely into scope.

India — DPDP phasing

The DPDP Rules 2025 commence in three phases. The Data Protection Board was established immediately. From **13 November 2026** it may hear complaints, conduct inquiries and levy penalties, and Consent Manager registration opens — enforcement powers arrive six months *before* the full compliance deadline of **13 May 2027**, not alongside it.

Good to know

Regional rules move constantly. The plugin's compliance notes are reviewed and refreshed with each release, so keeping up to date is the simplest way to stay current — there is nothing to reconfigure when guidance changes.

14. AI & Model Training Disclosure

Connecticut was the first US state to require your privacy notice to say plainly whether personal data is collected, used or sold to train large language models. Vermont imposes the same duty from 1 January 2028.

What the law asks

To answer it truthfully you need to know three things: whether your own products train or fine-tune models on user data, whether any of your suppliers may use your data to improve their models, and whether you sell or license data to anyone building AI systems. A vague line about using data to improve services does not answer it.

Configuring the disclosure

- Open **Settings › Advanced Consent** and find **AI / LLM Training Disclosure**.
- Tick the first box to include the section in your generated privacy policy.
- Then tick any of the three statements that apply — your own models, your vendors' models, or selling data into training datasets.
- Regenerate your privacy policy page so the new text appears.

If none apply, the plugin writes a clear statement that you do not collect, use or sell personal data to train large language models. That is the correct answer for most sites and worth stating plainly rather than staying silent.

Important

Check before you tick. An inaccurate statement in a public privacy notice is not only a privacy law problem — it can be treated as a deceptive business practice. The answer about vendors usually requires reading your suppliers' terms, because many reserve the right to use customer data for model improvement by default.

Note

These settings are excluded from settings export and import. They drive a legal statement about your business's data practices, and carrying them to another site would publish a claim nobody there ever made.

15. Privacy Policy & Cookie Policy Pages

The plugin can generate both a cookie policy and a privacy policy from your current settings, including the AI training disclosure. Both appear on the Dashboard.

- **Generate** creates the page.
- **Edit** opens it in the WordPress editor.
- **Regenerate** rewrites the content from your current settings.

Regenerating rewrites only the page content. The title, URL, published status and author are left alone, so a published policy stays published at the same address. The previous version is saved as a revision first.

Note

An existing policy page is never rewritten automatically. If you change a setting that affects it — the AI training disclosure being the common one — regenerate for the new text to appear. If you have been editing a generated policy by hand, review it first: your edits will be replaced, though the previous version remains as a revision.

16. Internationalisation & Community Translations

The banner can be shown in the visitor's own language, in 22 languages. Because a consent notice is a legal statement rather than ordinary interface text, nothing is shown to a visitor until you have read it and approved it.

Why the translations need your approval

They are contributed rather than professionally produced, and have not been checked by a qualified translator or a lawyer. An approximate translation of ordinary interface text is a minor annoyance; an approximate translation of a consent notice is a compliance risk, and it is your site that carries it.

Reviewing and approving a language

- Open **MBR Cookie Consent > Translations** for the list and its status.
- Select **Review** to see every string with your English beside the translation. Right-to-left languages display in the correct direction.
- Tick the confirmation and select **Approve**. The confirmation is required.
- Enable **Auto-Translation** under Settings once at least one language is approved.

Tip

Approve the languages you or a colleague can actually read, and leave the rest. Six approved languages covering most of your traffic is a better position than twenty-two nobody has checked, and the unapproved ones cost you nothing — those visitors simply see your own wording.

Your own wording is never overwritten

If you have rewritten a string, it is never replaced by a translation. There is no community translation of your wording, and showing your actual words in English is more accurate than showing a generic sentence in French that says something subtly different.

Available languages

Region	Languages
Western Europe	French, German, Spanish, Italian, Portuguese, Dutch

Region	Languages
Northern Europe	Swedish, Danish, Norwegian, Finnish
Central & Eastern Europe	Polish, Czech, Russian, Greek
Asia	Japanese, Chinese, Korean, Thai, Vietnamese
Middle East	Arabic, Hebrew, Turkish

The language swap happens in the browser, not on the server. Choosing a language while building the page would write one visitor's language into a copy a cache then serves to everybody. Where WPML or Polylang is active it takes precedence for its own languages, since it varies the page address and is therefore safe to apply on the server.

17. Accessibility

The banner and Preference Centre are built to WCAG 2.1 AA so that consent is genuinely available to every visitor, not just those using a mouse.

- Full keyboard navigation throughout the banner and Preference Centre.
- Screen reader support with appropriate ARIA roles and labels.
- A focus trap keeps keyboard focus within the modal while it is open.
- Visible focus indicators so keyboard users always know where they are.
- Visitors who have asked their system for reduced transparency are served a solid banner surface rather than the glass effect.

These are controlled by **Enable WCAG/ADA Compliance Features**, under Settings > Int'l & Accessibility. It is on by default, and there is rarely a good reason to turn it off.

Tip

If you heavily restyle the banner colours, re-check contrast afterwards. Accessibility is built in, but custom colours are your responsibility to keep within AA ratios — the live readout in section 6 is the quickest way to confirm it.

18. Consent Logging & Records of Consent

Being able to demonstrate consent is as important as collecting it.

- Each interaction is logged with its timestamp and the categories chosen.
- IP addresses are anonymised in line with GDPR expectations. IPv6 addresses are truncated by 80 bits.
- Records are exportable to CSV for your own audit and retention processes.
- Old records can be pruned on demand; the plugin asks for confirmation first and refuses a retention period below one day.

The visitor fingerprint

Alongside the anonymised IP address, each row carries a one-way fingerprint derived from the visitor's IP address and browser identification string, letting repeat interactions be grouped without keeping the raw address. It is keyed with a salt unique to your site that never leaves your server.

Note

The export column is headed **Visitor Hash**. It has never been a hash of the consent cookie, and a compliance export should not mislabel its own columns. Rows written before 2.3.5 used an unsalted value and will not match later rows; nothing queries the column, so the only consequence is a discontinuity in the history.

Is it working?

The Consent Doctor reports whether rows are genuinely reaching the database, when the most recent arrived, and whether any recent write failed — which a total row count cannot show you, because an intermittent fault hides behind a healthy-looking number. See section 20.

Good to know

The logging endpoint accepts unauthenticated requests by design, because a nonce baked into cached HTML goes stale and would block genuine consent records. It is throttled per visitor, category names are validated against the categories your site has registered, and CSV exports are protected against spreadsheet formula injection.

Important

Consent records are personal data. Store exports securely, keep them only as long as you need them, and include them in your own retention and deletion routines. They are excluded from the settings export, and are never removed by an update, by deactivation, or even by deleting the plugin — removing that data is always a deliberate act on your part.

19. A/B Testing

Compare banner variations to see which earns clearer, higher-quality consent. Visitors are assigned at random to one of three layouts, in the browser, so the page stays identical for everyone and safe to cache. A/B testing is **off by default**.

- Test wording, layout or button styling against each other.
- Compare acceptance behaviour between the variants.
- Adopt the stronger performer once you have enough data — **Promote winner** writes its layout into your banner settings and switches testing off.

Important

Statistics gathered before 2.3.5 describe your cache rather than your visitors, because the variant was chosen on the server and baked into the cached page. Reset your statistics before drawing conclusions from an older test.

Note

Optimise for clarity and informed choice, not for the highest possible accept rate. A banner engineered purely to maximise acceptance can undermine the validity of the consent you collect.

20. Consent Doctor

The Consent Doctor answers one question: **is my consent setup actually working?** It is read-only — nothing on the screen changes a setting.

It exists because a consent plugin can look perfectly configured and do nothing. Two services described in section 9 were listed as blocked for a long time and never were. The settings were right; the behaviour was not; and no screen

in the plugin showed the difference.

Three kinds of evidence

Checks are grouped by how strong the evidence behind them is, and the grouping is enforced rather than suggested.

Tier	What it is	Can it say “working”?
Observed in a browser	The network requests a real page load actually made.	Yes
Observed on the server	Rows written, lookups resolved, schema changes that took.	Yes
Configuration	What your settings say.	Never

Important

That last row is the whole point. Reading a setting tells you what the plugin *intends* to do, not what it did. A configuration check can therefore report “configured”, never “working” — finding a blocking rule is not proof that no tracking request escaped.

What it checks

Observed on the server

- Whether consent logging is genuinely writing rows, and when the last one arrived.
- Whether any recent write failed — reported separately, because an intermittent fault never shows up in a record count.
- Which privacy region is actually being applied, how it was arrived at, and whether that answer was resolved just now or read from cache.
- Whether the consent log schema change took.

Configuration

- What your blocking rules cover, by category.
- Whether script blocking is switched off entirely — the banner still collects a choice that nothing acts on, which is the arrangement regulators specifically object to.
- Page exclusions that also stop consent being enforced.
- Competing consent plugins. Two on one site will fight: two banners, two cookies, and each unblocking what the other holds.
- Several Google tag rules registered, which often means double-counting.
- HTTPS, subdomain consent sharing, and whether your page cache is one the plugin can purge when you save.

The live check

This is the part that can answer the actual question. It loads a page of your site in a hidden frame and records every network request the page makes, then cross-references the hosts against your blocking rules.

Scripts injected at runtime — most tag manager containers, anything added by a theme or another plugin after the page is built — never appear in a server-side audit at all. They appear here.

- Choose a page from the list, or paste any URL on your site.
- **Simulate a first-time visitor** is on by default: your own consent choice is set aside for the check and restored afterwards.
- Every finding names the page it came from.

Important

Run it on more than your home page. Comment threads and embedded video are where tracking escapes, and a home page with neither will always pass. The suggestions list your most-commented and most recently updated pages for exactly that reason.

Note

A content blocker in your own browser invalidates the result. It suppresses the very requests being measured, so a clean result means nothing. The check detects this — using a control element, so that “nothing was measurable” is never mistaken for “a blocker was present” — and marks its findings inconclusive rather than passing them. The same applies if the page checked had already been consented to.

If the check does not report back

It will tell you where it stopped rather than shrugging: whether the page never loaded, redirected to another origin, loaded without the diagnostic parameters, or loaded and had its script held back by a performance plugin that delays JavaScript until someone interacts with the page. Nobody ever interacts with a background frame.

There is also an **Open the probe page directly** link, which loads exactly what the check loads in a normal tab, so you can watch it yourself.

What it still cannot tell you

- It covers the page that was checked, not the whole site.
- Requests made inside a cross-origin frame — the contents of a YouTube embed — cannot be seen from outside it. The frame loading at all is usually the finding, and that is visible.
- Content loaded only when a visitor scrolls may not be triggered.

Important

The Consent Doctor counts findings. It does not tell you that your site is compliant, and it is deliberately not written as though it could. No automated check can make that judgement, and one that implied otherwise would be worse than none.

21. Multisite Support

- Activate across the network, or per individual site, as you prefer.
- Apply a consistent baseline configuration to every site on the network.
- Allow individual sites to keep their own settings where they differ.
- New sites added to the network pick up the network configuration automatically.

Note

Network settings are shared, but page caches are not — each site holds its own. Saving network settings purges the cache of the site you saved from; others pick the change up as their caches expire.

22. Importing & Exporting Settings

Configure one site exactly as you want it, then reproduce that configuration on any number of other installs without re-keying a field.

Category	Detail
Included	Banner appearance and text, glassmorphism, dark mode, logo URL, banner behaviour, cookie categories, blocked rules, Google and Microsoft Consent Mode, GPC, form integration, page exclusions, custom CSS, subdomain sharing, policy link toggles and URLs, and regional headings.
Never included	Consent logs. Visitor personal data stays with the site that collected it — use the CSV export instead.
Site-local, excluded	Policy page IDs, the geolocation lookup cache, version markers, the logo's attachment ID, visitor IP detection mode and trusted proxies, the Cloudflare header trust setting, the ip-api.com pro key, the plain-HTTP opt-in, the AI training disclosure, and approved translations.

Each excluded value is a fact about one site rather than a preference worth reproducing. An attachment ID refers to a different image elsewhere. Which proxy a site sits behind is a property of that server. A credential should not ride along in a file that gets emailed around. An approved translation records that a particular person read that language and took responsibility for publishing it, which is not a responsibility that transfers with a settings file.

Undoing an import

- The settings about to change are backed up automatically before an import is applied.
- **Revert last import** restores them in one step and purges the cache again.
- Only the most recent import can be reverted. Treat it as a safety net, not a version history.

23. Caching & Performance

The plugin is safe to run behind a page cache. That sounds like a small claim, and getting there took several releases.

A page cache stores one copy of a page and serves it to everybody, so anything the server writes into that page based on who is asking will be served to everyone who follows. Every such case was moved into the browser:

What used to vary on the server	Fixed in
Script and embed blocking, decided from the visitor's consent cookie	2.3.3
Google and Microsoft Consent Mode defaults	2.3.3
Global Privacy Control state	2.3.3
Banner language	2.3.3
Regional banner wording and behaviour	2.3.4
The 'Do Not Sell or Share' link	2.3.4
A/B testing variant assignment	2.3.5

Nothing that varies by visitor is now written into the page. Every visitor receives an identical document with everything non-necessary held, a denied consent default, and no regional or GPC state at all. Their own choice is applied in their browser.

Purging on save

Saving your settings purges the page cache automatically, so a change shows up straight away instead of waiting for the cache to expire — which used to look exactly like the save had failed.

- SiteGround Speed Optimizer · WP Rocket · LiteSpeed Cache · W3 Total Cache
- WP Super Cache · WP Fastest Cache · WP-Optimize · Cache Enabler
- Breeze · Nginx Helper · WP Engine

Note

If your cache is not on that list, the Consent Doctor will say so — it detects that a page cache is active and warns when it is one the plugin cannot purge, because your banner changes will then not appear until the cache expires on its own. There are also filters and actions for hooking your own cache layer in.

24. CCPA and ‘Do Not Sell or Share’

- An optional **Do Not Sell or Share My Personal Information** link is available.
- Selecting it records the visitor’s opt-out and applies it to the relevant categories.
- Global Privacy Control signals are honoured as a valid opt-out automatically, decided in the browser so a cached page cannot carry one visitor’s signal to everybody.

25. Troubleshooting & FAQ

A service I have a rule for is still being contacted

Run the live check in section 20 — it will name the host and, from what made the request, usually the reason. The common one is a rule of the wrong type: a rule against an avatar or a tracking pixel must be type **Image**, and one against a web font or external CSS must be type **Stylesheet**. Before 2.4.8 neither type existed, so such a rule could not work however it was configured.

My fonts changed after updating to 2.4.8

Expected. Google Fonts is now genuinely held until consent, where previously it was listed as blocked but never was. Visitors see a system font until they accept. Self-hosting your font files removes the disclosure entirely and keeps your typography consistent before and after consent — usually the better answer.

The live check hangs or reports nothing

It will name where it stopped. If it mentions a performance plugin, exclude the consent and diagnostic scripts from JavaScript delay — a script held until someone interacts with the page will never run in a background frame. If it says the screen is running a cached copy of its own script, hard-refresh with Ctrl-F5 or Cmd-Shift-R and purge your asset cache.

The banner does not appear

You have most likely already recorded a consent choice in your current browser. Test in a private window, or clear the plugin’s stored consent for your site.

My banner changes are not showing on the front end

The page cache is purged automatically when you save. If a change still does not appear, clear your browser cache first — it sits outside anything the plugin can reach. Then check whether the Consent Doctor has warned that your cache is one it cannot purge.

The wrong region's banner appears

Check the **Source** line on the Geolocation screen. If it says not detected, you are seeing your default region rather than a lookup result, and every visitor whose location cannot be resolved is seeing it too. If it says the answer was cached, it describes an earlier lookup rather than the provider's current state.

Everyone sees the same region behind my CDN

Check **Visitor IP Detection**. The default trusts Cloudflare's header only when the request demonstrably came through Cloudflare. If you sit behind a different proxy, set the mode to **Trusted proxies** and supply its addresses, otherwise every visitor appears to arrive from the proxy itself.

My translated banner is still in English

Check three things in order: automatic translation enabled under Settings, at least one language approved on the Translations screen, and the visitor's browser asking for a language you have approved. A language that is available but not approved is deliberately not served. Strings you have rewritten yourself are never translated.

Settings will not save

The notice now says what the server actually reported. If it names a field, that one value was left alone and everything else saved. If it says the response could not be read, something on your site is printing a PHP error into it — check your error log.

Forms submit before consent is given

Confirm the form's required consent category is set under Form Builder Integration, and that the form plugin is one of the supported builders. Then test the full submit-block-accept-resubmit cycle in a private window.

Does this plugin slow my site down?

The consent layer is lightweight and loads early so it can hold trackers on the first view. If you also run a performance plugin that delays JavaScript, make sure the consent script is excluded from that delay so it is ready before trackers fire.

26. Support, Feedback & Resources

Your feedback shapes the plugin. Bug reports are fixed quickly, and the best features come from real users describing what they need — import and export began that way, and the Consent Doctor exists because it was worth being able to prove the plugin was doing what it claimed. Two services it immediately found were not.

Resource	Where
Plugin home	littlewebshack.com/mbr-cookie-consent/
Source & issues	github.com/HarbourBob/MBR-Cookie-Consent
Email	info@littlewebshack.com
More plugins & dev tools	littlewebshack.com

Good to know

MBR Cookie Consent is free and GPL-licensed. No upsells, no tracking, no vendor lock-in. © 2026 Robert Palmer · Little Web Shack · Built in Cleethorpes, UK.